But very few knew that while Kiran was striving to set right the policing system, she was all along doing so with a severe handicap. Kiran's mother was battling for her life. After suffering a cerebral stroke, her mother was lying in coma at the Chandigarh Post-Graduate Institute (a prime medical institute with a hospital). Kiran's mother had travelled with her to Chandigarh. She was very fond of Kiran; both shared an intensely loving mother–daughter relationship – almost an ideal one. Kiran had never seen her mother sick, and here she was in deep coma. Kiran, her sisters and her father thought it might be worth trying to bring her back to Delhi. Maybe the change of atmosphere would work, for she would be home again. Such a miracle had happened for Kiran in the case of her father when she was posted to Aizwal (Mizoram) and a near-fatal surgery had forced the airlifting of Kiran's father to Delhi (for details, see Chapter 12). Kiran sent a written request to the Government of India seeking a shift out of Chandigarh on the ground that her mother was in a critical condition. To take on the system in Chandigarh and see things through required undivided attention, which, under the prevailing circumstances, Kiran was in no position to give.

Kiran's request was granted by the Union Ministry of Home Affairs, and she handed over the charge. The first order her successor passed was to suspend the officers whom Kiran had declined to do so.

Kiran, meanwhile, had rushed to Delhi to look for a mobile intensive-care unit fitted within an ambulance, which could bring her mother to the capital from Chandigarh. The Escorts Heart Institute arranged for such an ambulance, and the family, with the unconscious mother, sped back, with the siren clearing the way to Delhi. They went straight to the hospital, praying for the miracle to happen again. But Kiran's mother never regained consciousness and succumbed three days later. She had remained in coma for 41 days.

Kiran went back to Chandigarh to say the closing prayers in the *mandir* and the *gurdwara* where non-stop prayers and reading from the holy books for the recovery of her mother had been started by hundreds of policemen and their families from the day of her mother's hospitalization. Kiran's mother had been hospitalized for 41 days. The prayers had been recited 41 times. Kiran had been with Chandigarh Police for 41 days and she was posted back to training after these 41 days.

---

* Evidential document of the home secretary bypassing the authority of the IG by issuing transfer orders.
* Evidential document of the home secretary's suspension orders.
* Evidential document of the home secretary's suspension orders.
* Evidential document of the home secretary's transfer orders.
* Evidential document of the cancellation of her own order by the home secretary.